

County Administration Workshop: July 21, 2026

1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson (excused); and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The board declared there are no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Parks

1. Whitehorse Park - Aegis Asphalt Construction Change Order \$86,499.95

Tamra Martin, Recreation Director, presented a construction change order with Aegis Asphalt in the amount of **\$86,499.95** for the Whitehorse Park renovation project. Ms. Martin explained that the original paving contract primarily covered the individual camping sites, driveways, and parking areas. After accumulated material was removed and the connections between the newly improved areas and the existing roadway became visible, staff determined that an overlay of the entire roadway was also necessary. Completing the roadway at the same time would create a cleaner finished appearance, improve the connections between the sites and road, and extend the useful life of the improvements. The overall renovation remained under budget because Parks staff had completed a significant portion of the work in-house. Funding for the change order would come from the Parks Capital Fund and the Land and Water Conservation Fund grant awarded for the project. Ms. Martin reported that the completed upper area would include ten additional RV sites and five campsites. She also noted that the project design allowed the County to preserve the mature trees and shaded character of the park.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve signing Authority to Tamra Martin, Recreation Director for the Whitehorse Park - Aegis Asphalt Construction Change Order \$86,499.95. Seconded by Commissioner Smith. Upon Roll Call: Commissioner Richardson – Absent, Commissioner Martin – Yes, Commissioner Smith – Yes. Motion carried 2-0.

b. Community Development

**1. BCC Ordinance 2026-002 for Comp Plan Zone Change and Goal Exception
approved on April 8, 2026**

Tami Smith, Community Development, presented the remaining procedural steps for Ordinance No. 2026-002, involving an amendment of the Comprehensive Plan designation from Farm to Residential and a zone change from Farm Resource to Rural Residential Five-Acre.

The underlying land-use request had been approved on April 8, 2026. Community Development requested that the first reading of the ordinance be scheduled for August 19, 2026, followed by the second reading on September 2, 2026. Commissioners discussed the amount of time that had passed since approval of the land-use matter. Staff explained that the appeal period was 21 days and that additional time was needed to confirm whether an appeal had been filed, coordinate the Board's schedule, and provide the required newspaper notice. Commissioners requested that future ordinance proceedings be scheduled as promptly as possible following expiration of the appeal period. Without objection, the Board directed staff to schedule the first reading for August 19, 2026, and the second reading for September 2, 2026. No formal motion was required.

c. Information Technology

1. Xiologix Pure Storage NVMe-Now

Ken Clever, IT Director, presented a request to purchase updated drives for the County's Pure Storage array through Xiologix. Mr. Clever explained that the storage array contains County data, files, and application servers and is a central component of the County's daily computer operations.

The existing drives were approximately ten years old and were reaching the end of their supported life. Although the storage unit and controllers remained serviceable, the manufacturer was discontinuing its drive buyback program at the end of July. Completing the purchase before that deadline would allow the County to receive a substantial credit for the existing drives and avoid a significantly higher replacement cost.

The replacement had been included in the Information Technology capital budget. The cost had increased by approximately \$3,000 since the budget was prepared, but the department could absorb the difference. Mr. Clever anticipated that the updated drives could remain in service for another ten to fifteen years.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Purchase Xiologix Pure Storage NVMe-Now. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – Absent, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 2-0.

2. Employee Email Access

Ken Clever, IT Director, requested authorization under the County's existing policy to provide access to the email accounts of former employees. The requests included:

- Access by Rob Brandes to the former email account of Shannon Doak.
- Access by Caitlin Carpajal to the former email account of Kaylee Carter.
- Access by Janet Feddickson to the former email account of Mark Stevenson for information potentially related to Environmental Health.

Commissioners supported the first two requests. Regarding the Mark Stevenson account, the Board discussed whether Information Technology could locate and provide only the specific records needed rather than granting access to the entire mailbox. Because of potential litigation concerns, the Board directed Mr. Clever to consult Legal Counsel before proceeding with that request. The Board requested that Information Technology continue developing a revised policy establishing a routine process for handling employee email accounts following separation from County employment. Mr. Clever agreed to prioritize the policy update.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Employee Email Access. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – Absent, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 2-0.

d. Human Resources

1. Bargaining Agreement

- a) Approval of Collective Bargaining Agreement between Josephine County and Laborers' International Union of North America, Oregon and Southern Idaho District Council of Labors, (LiUNA) Local 737

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director presented a collective bargaining agreement between Josephine County and the Laborers' International Union of North America, Oregon and Southern Idaho District Council of Laborers, Local 737, representing Public Works road and mechanic employees. Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe reported that the parties had reached an agreement and requested authorization for the Board to execute it. The agreement is a one-year extension. Rather than preparing a separate addendum, the negotiated revisions were incorporated directly into the agreement so that portions of the document would already be updated when negotiations resume the following year.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Collective Bargaining Agreement between Josephine County and Laborers' International Union of North America, Oregon and Southern Idaho District Council of Labors, (LiUNA) Local 737. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. Position Requisitions

- a) Sheriff-Corporal Patrol-Re-fill vacant position, vacated July 2026
- b) Sheriff-Deputy Patrol-Re-fill vacant position, vacated June 2026
- c) Sheriff -Deputy Major Crimes -Add Two Positions -Approved in 26-27 Budget

d) Sheriff-Deputy Patrol-Add Eight Positions -Approved in 26-27 Budget

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director explained that the first two requests involved replacing employees who had been promoted or had left County employment. The remaining ten positions—two Major Crimes detectives and eight patrol deputies—had been authorized through the adopted budget. Chair Smith emphasized the importance of the Major Crimes detective positions to the investigation and prevention of criminal activity. The Board acknowledged that the Sheriff may have difficulty filling all eight new patrol positions because of the limited number of qualified applicants and the training requirements for newly hired deputies. No additional formal action was required because the positions had already been approved through the budget process.

3. Board Business**a. Association of Oregon Counties – Dues \$41,329.93**

The Board considered annual Association of Oregon Counties membership dues in the amount of \$41,329.93. Commissioners explained that County membership in the Association of Oregon Counties is a prerequisite for participation in CIS insurance programs. CIS provides the County with liability coverage, workers' compensation services, employee benefits support, claims management, legal defense, training, loss prevention, and risk-management assistance. The Board noted that the dues therefore support more than general association activities and are necessary for maintaining essential County insurance coverage. *Commissioner Martin moved to approve Association of Oregon Counties – Dues \$41,329.93. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon Roll Call: Commissioner Richardson – absent; Commissioner Martin – Yes; Commissioner Smith – Yes. Motion carried 2-0.*

b. Communications

Commissioner Martin provided an update regarding the County's public safety radio communications system. She reported that letters had been sent to three state or congressional representatives seeking information regarding possible grants or loans to assist with the cost of repairing and replacing the system. The Board had previously approved approximately \$85,000 for an interim repair. The necessary equipment had been ordered, but the projected delivery date was approximately September 11, 2026, despite efforts to expedite the order. Commissioners explained that the radio system supports the Sheriff's Office, Emergency Management, and other first responders. The current system had been repaired repeatedly and required complete modernization. Commissioner Martin stated that she would continue exploring FEMA, State Emergency Management, and other grant opportunities before the County considered alternative financing for the full replacement project. No formal action was taken.

3. OTHER

None heard

4. ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:

Commissioner Smiths discussed the East Evans Creek Fire and recent fires in the Illinois Valley. He urged the public to remain extremely cautious because a significant portion of the fire season remained.

Chair Smith also encouraged residents to register for the **Everbridge emergency notification system**, which provides current evacuation notices and other emergency information.

The meeting adjourned at 1:54 p.m.